

Message History (4)

On 6/10/2026 12:25:37 AM, Brian C wrote:

Thank you for the response to Item 4. I would like to follow up on the Government Code 7927.705 / Evidence Code 954 withholding. Item 4's scope includes communications among Records Unit staff, the City Clerk, and Department supervisors. As you are aware, the attorney-client privilege under Evidence Code sections 952 and 954 covers confidential communications between client and counsel made for the purpose of legal consultation, and your response does not state that every responsive communication is of that character. As you are also aware, the City has itself issued aggregate staff-time statements about my requests — the May 5, 2026 letter on W012462-040226 stated that "City staff are dedicating approximately 10 hours per week to triaging your requests." With that in mind:

1. Please state whether any communications responsive to Item 4 exist on which no attorney is an author or recipient, and produce them.
2. For responsive communications that do include counsel, please produce any reasonably segregable portions under Government Code section 7922.525(b) — the section your response cites — with privileged matter redacted.
3. If the City's position is that every communication responsive to Item 4 is a confidential attorney-client communication made for the purpose of legal consultation, please confirm that position in writing.
4. Regarding the May 5, 2026 statement that City staff are dedicating "approximately 10 hours per week to triaging your requests" — an aggregate figure across my pending requests — and the 211,872-document scope stated in the same letter: please state how each figure was determined, and whether any internal communications discussed, transmitted, or calculated either figure. If such communications exist, they fall within Item 4's scope — please produce them, or identify the exemption asserted for each withheld communication per Government Code section 7922.540. If the City's position is that these figures were determined without any internal written communication, please confirm that in writing.

Thank you,
Brian

On 6/4/2026 2:36:25 PM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:

Subject: California Public Records Request :: W012790-052526

Body:

RE: PUBLIC RECORDS REQUEST of May 25, 2026, **Reference # W012790-052526**

Dear Brian C,

The City received the following records request from you on May 25, 2026.

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act (Gov. Code § 7920.000 et seq.), I request the following records from the San Mateo Police Department and, to the extent jointly held, the City of San Mateo.

This request is for existing records only (Gov. Code § 7922.530; Sierra Club v. Superior Court (2013) 57 Cal.4th 157). It does not ask the Department or the City to compile, count, calculate, summarize, or aggregate; it asks for the existing per-case logs, time entries, reports, and communications described below, produced in their existing form (with standard personnel-information redactions where appropriate).

CONTEXT

As you are aware, the Department has received and processed the public records requests listed below. As you already know, the Department has, in the course of communicating with me about those requests, characterized them as requiring substantial staff time — including a figure of approximately 10 hours of staff time attributed to my requests. This request seeks the existing records by which the Department and the City track, log, and attribute staff time and case activity to specific PRA case numbers.

PRA CASE NUMBERS WITHIN SCOPE

W012129-020926, W012159-021226, W012160-021226, W012174-021826, W012198-022326, W012201-022326, W012297-030826, W012320-031126, W012328-031226, W012339-031326, W012373-032026, W012376-032026, W012459-040226, W012460-040226, W012461-040226, W012462-040226, W012541-041426, W012570-041926, W012571-042026, W012596-042226, W012597-042226, W012663-050426, W012664-050426, W012665-050426, W012666-050426, W012672-050426, W012674-050426, W012683-050626, W012686-050726, W012693-050726, W012741-051426, W012742-051426.

RECORDS REQUESTED

1. Per-case activity / audit logs from the PRA management system. For each request within scope, the complete activity log, audit trail, case-note log, or equivalent timestamped record maintained by the Department's and/or the City's public records request management platform (e.g., NextRequest, JustFOIA, GovQA, or whichever software is in use), including: every logged entry, the timestamp of the entry, the action taken (e.g., assignment, document upload, internal note, status change, extension, response sent), and the user or staff member associated with the entry.

2. Per-case staff-time / labor attribution records. Any report, dashboard view, spreadsheet, export, internal memo, or other record that attributes or aggregates staff hours, labor time, or labor cost to specific PRA case numbers — including any per-PRA hour totals, breakdowns, or rollups in which any case number within scope appears.

*3. Timesheet / labor-distribution records linkable to my case numbers. Timesheet entries, time-tracking system records, labor distribution records, or activity coding records in which Department or City staff have coded hours to a "Public Records," "CPRA," or equivalent project, task, cost center, or case-number code, to the extent those entries are linkable to any case number within scope. Standard personnel-information redactions (e.g., Social Security number, home address, payroll detail) are acceptable on a cell-by-cell basis; the data sought is the per-case staff-hour attribution, not employee compensation detail. If the time-tracking system records hours at a project- or department-aggregate level rather than per case, please produce the aggregate-level records reflecting "Public Records" or equivalent coding for the staff members who appear in the per-case activity logs produced under Item 1. **No responsive records.***

4. *Internal communications referencing time on my requests. Internal communications (email, Microsoft Teams, Slack, SMS, or other channel) among Department or City staff — including but not limited to the City Attorney's office, the City Clerk, the Records Unit, and Department supervisors — that reference the time required, anticipated, or expended on any case number within scope, or that reference my requests in the aggregate by reference to staff time, workload, or burden.*

A legal review of your request was completed by our City Attorney's office, in accordance with Government Code § 7922.525(b). During this review, it was determined that the records you have requested are exempt from disclosure as determined by the following Public Records Act exemptions:

California Government Code § 7927.705 exempts records protected by privileges under the Evidence Code. This includes attorney-client privileged communications pursuant to California Evidence Code section 954.

5. *Communications-policy and time-tracking SOPs. Any standard operating procedure, written guideline, training material, or policy document governing how Department and City staff are expected to log, track, code, or attribute staff time to public records requests, and any document describing the configuration of the PRA management system's case-note, activity-log, or time-tracking features. **Responsive record uploaded to portal.***

NOTES ON FORM OF PRODUCTION

- *The records sought in Items 1, 2, and 5 are routine system exports and internal documents; please produce in native format (CSV, XLSX, PDF, or the system's standard export format) without re-keying.*
- *For Item 3, segregable cell-level redaction of employee personal-information cells (e.g., the employee-identifier column) is acceptable; the per-case hour-attribution columns are not personnel-record content within the meaning of Gov. Code § 7927.700.*
- *For Item 4, standard attorney-client privilege and deliberative-process review is anticipated; please produce non-privileged communications and provide a privilege log identifying any communication withheld, per Gov. Code § 7922.540.*

VENDOR-HOSTED RECORDS

To the extent any responsive record is held within a vendor-hosted system on the Department's or the City's behalf (e.g., a SaaS PRA management platform, a SaaS timekeeping platform), City of San Jose v. Superior Court (2017) 2 Cal.5th 608 and Gov. Code § 7920.530 establish that records held by a vendor in the performance of the agency's business are agency records subject to production.

IF THE REQUEST IS DENIED

If any record is withheld in whole or in part, please:

1. *provide specific exemption citations per Gov. Code § 7922.540, identifying the basis for withholding each record or category of cell; and*

2. for any record withheld on personnel-privacy grounds, identify whether the per-case staff-hour attribution data can be produced with employee-identifier columns redacted, consistent with the segregability requirement of Gov. Code § 7922.525(b).

Thank you.

Due to the large number of records which are associated with this request, the City will send you records on a rolling production basis. An initial batch of records has been released and made available on the San Mateo Records Request Portal. You will be receiving more batches of responsive records in the future. Select the link below to view what is currently available.

We will further respond to your request with updates no later than 6/18/26.

If you have any questions, please contact me using the below contact information.

Sincerely,

Juliana Santiago
Management Analyst
Police
650-522-7600

On 5/25/2026 10:18:04 PM, Brian C wrote:

Request Created on Public Portal

On 5/25/2026 10:17:41 PM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:



Thank you for your interest in public records of the City of San Mateo. Your request was received by the City of San Mateo on 5/25/2026 and given the reference number **W012790-052526** for tracking purposes.

Record(s) Requested: Pursuant to the California Public Records Act (Gov. Code § 7920.000 et seq.), I request the following records from the San Mateo Police Department and, to the extent jointly held, the City of San Mateo.

This request is for existing records only (Gov. Code § 7922.530; *Sierra Club v. Superior Court* (2013) 57 Cal.4th 157). It does not ask the Department or the City to compile, count, calculate, summarize, or aggregate; it asks for the existing per-case logs, time entries, reports, and communications described below, produced in their existing form (with standard personnel-information redactions where appropriate).

CONTEXT

As you are aware, the Department has received and processed the public records requests listed below. As you already know, the Department has, in the course of communicating with me about those requests, characterized them as requiring substantial staff time — including a figure of approximately 10 hours of staff time attributed to my requests. This request seeks the existing records by which the Department and the City track, log, and attribute staff time and case activity to specific PRA case numbers.

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personnel-information redactions (e.g., Social Security number, home address, payroll detail) are acceptable on a cell-by-cell basis; the data sought is the per-case staff-hour attribution, not employee compensation detail. If the time-tracking system records hours at a project- or department-aggregate level rather than per case, please produce the aggregate-level records reflecting "Public Records" or equivalent coding for the staff members who appear in the per-case activity logs produced under Item 1.

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2. for any record withheld on personnel-privacy grounds, identify whether the per-case staff-hour attribution data can be produced with employee-identifier columns redacted, consistent with the segregability requirement of Gov. Code § 7922.525(b).

Thank you.

The request is being forwarded to appropriate department(s) for processing.

Monitor request progress at the link below. The City will email you when the request is complete. Thank you for using the San Mateo Records Center.

To monitor the progress or update this request please log into the [San Mateo Records Center](#).